MONTHLY UPDATE

Niger: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-16 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *Developments reported in sources published between the beginning of last month and today, grouped by story, oldest first.*

STATUS · PROGRESS · INSTITUTION HOSTING

GOVERNANCE
Legislation and regulation · Regional collaboration · Public debate and participation in policymaking

FINANCE
MoUs and other agreements

ICT INFRASTRUCTURE
Connectivity

DPI
Digital Identity and CRVS · Digital Payments and Fintech · Other GovTech and e-Gov

CAPACITY
Literacy · Training and skills

INCLUSION
Access to services

Governance

Legislation and regulation

DRAFT ORDINANCE ON THE ELECTRONIC PRESS

- **Conclusions du Conseil des ministres du jeudi 10 septembre 2026** — Gouvernement du Niger, 10 September 2026

  Council of Ministers 2026-09-10: draft ordinance on electronic press, decree on foreign-press accreditation.

- **Niger's Media Adjustment: Regulation, Control, and the Shrinking Newsroom in the Sahel** — ModernGhana, 15 September 2026

  The council of ministers approved an overhaul of the media regulatory framework on 10 September, tightening accreditation for foreign correspondents and carrying a draft ordinance requiring online press publishers to be identified, with legal responsibility on digital newsrooms for what they carry.

ARRETE ON COMMERCIAL WI-FI ZONE PROVISION

- **Le CFAIC plaide pour une réglementation adaptée aux réalités des Wifi Zones au Niger - Agence Nigérienne de Presse** — Agence Nigérienne de Presse, 20 September 2026

  Collective calls arrêté 000034 its "birth certificate" but wants fees, equipment caps and a six-month grace revisited.

Regional collaboration

PLATFORM OF AES MEDIA AND COMMUNICATION REGULATORS (PAREMEC)

- **AES : Création à Niamey d'une plateforme des régulateurs des médias et communication de l'espace communautaire** — Agence Nigérienne de Presse, 17 September 2026

  AES media regulators constitutive conference, Niamey 17-18 September 2026, on informational sovereignty.

- **Fin des travaux de l'assemblée générale constitutive des régulateurs de la communication AES: Le Malien Coulibaly Gaoussou devient le 1er président de la plateforme - Agence Nigérienne de Presse** — Agence Nigérienne de Presse, 18 September 2026

  Mali's HAC head Coulibaly Gaoussou first president; charter signed, rules and action plan adopted, seat in Niamey.

COOPERATION CONVENTION OF THE CONFEDERATION TELECOMMUNICATIONS REGULATORS (CONSEIL DES RÉGULATEURS DU SAHEL)

- **Coopération régionale entre les régulateurs de l'AES : Signature d'une convention de coopération le 25 septembre 2026 à Ouagadougou** — leFaso.net (communiqué of ARCEP Burkina Faso), 23 September 2026 BURKINA FASO MALI WEST AFRICA

  The telecoms regulators of Burkina Faso, Mali and Niger are to sign a cooperation agreement in Ouagadougou on 25 September creating a Sahel Regulators' Council. It covers roaming within the Alliance of Sahel States, consumer protection, cybersecurity, spectrum, mutual recognition of type-approved equipment and joint positions in international bodies.

- **Espace AES : Les régulateurs des télécommunications créent le Conseil des régulateurs du Sahel** — leFaso.net, 26 September 2026 BURKINA FASO MALI WEST AFRICA

  Burkina, Mali, Niger regulators sign convention: five priorities, free roaming, border spectrum, coordinated 5G.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

MEDIA AND PLATFORM MONITORING AFTER THE EVENTS OF 28-29 AUGUST 2026

- **Medias : Ameliorer l''ecosysteme de l''information et de la communication en temps de crise au centre d''une rencontre a Niamey** — Agence Nigerienne de Presse (ANP), 2 September 2026

  ONC monitored broadcast, online and platform content 28 August-1 September after the Niamey incident.

- **Rencontre entre le ministre charge de la Communication, le president de l''ONC et les promoteurs de medias : l''ONC devoile les conclusions d''un monitoring** — Le Sahel (ONEP), 3 September 2026

  Monitoring of 28 August to 1 September coverage after the Niamey incidents, with old images recirculated.

Finance

MoUs and other agreements

ALGÉRIE TÉLÉCOM CONVENTIONS WITH NIGER TELECOM AND THE NATIONAL TELECOMS SCHOOL

- **Cooperation : Algerie Telecom signe deux conventions de partenariat avec Niger Telecom et ESCEP-Niger** — Agence Nigerienne de Presse, 8 September 2026 ALGERIA

  Skills Centre at ESCEP-Niger plus donated kit for a 100 Gbps Ngezam-Agadez fibre link.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

OPERATOR PROMOTIONAL DATA TARIFFS

- **Avec 500F bénéficiez de 3.5Go de 23H à 06H pour naviguer en toute sérénité** — Moov Africa Niger, 1 September 2026

  Moov Africa Niger offers a 3.5GB night bundle at roughly 143 FCFA per GB.

MOBILE NETWORK SERVICE QUALITY

- **L'air du temps : Le reseau mobile : mauvaise qualite et desarroi des usagers** — Le Sahel (ONEP), 4 September 2026

  Niger's electronic communications and post regulator launched a campaign on 27 July to verify mobile network coverage and the voice and data service map. A press account reports users facing poor quality for several months - interrupted calls, correspondents shown as unavailable or engaged - with the regulator's expert findings still awaited.

IN GUEZZAM TO ARLIT-AGADEZ FIBRE LINK WITH ALGERIA

- **Coopération Niger-Algérie : arrivée du ministre Hamani Kargné à Agadez pour le lancement des travaux d'interconnexion par fibre optique** — Ministère de la Communication et des Nouvelles Technologies de l'Information (Niger), 6 October 2026 ALGERIA

  Niger's communications ministry reported its minister's arrival at Agadez on 5 October with an Algerian delegation, describing the mission as the launch of fibre interconnection works between the two countries; the ceremony itself is summarised above.

- **L'Algérie et le Niger lancent l'exploitation de la dorsale transsaharienne à fibre optique** — Algérie Eco (reporting Algérie Presse Service), 6 October 2026 ALGERIA

  The Algerian account of the Assamaka ceremony, summarised above, says the link was built by Algerie Telecom and Niger Telecom, starts at 100 Gbps and can be expanded as traffic grows.

- **Niger-Algérie : lancement à Assamaka de l'exploitation de la dorsale transsaharienne à fibre optique** — Agence Nigérienne de Presse, 6 October 2026 ALGERIA

  Niger and Algeria launched operation of the fibre link between In Guezzam and the Arlit-Agadez region at a ceremony at Assamaka, on the border, on 6 October, chaired by the two communications ministers. Algeria's account gives a starting capacity of 100 Gbps.

DPI

Digital Identity and CRVS

AGENCE NATIONALE DE L'ENREGISTREMENT ET DE L'IDENTIFICATION DES PERSONNES PHYSIQUES

- **Diffa : lancement de la tournee nationale de sensibilisation sur la modernisation de l''etat civil et l''identification** — Agence Nigerienne de Presse (ANP), 3 September 2026

  National sensitisation tour on civil-registration and identification reform opens at Diffa under WURI-Niger.

AES BIOMETRIC PASSPORT

- **Niger : l'enrôlement pour le passeport biométrique AES débute le 15 septembre 2026** — NigerDiaspora, 9 September 2026

  Mass AES passport enrolment from 15 September 2026; 45,000 FCFA, ECOWAS enrolment closes 10 September.

- **From ECOWAS to AES: Niger Completes Its Passport Break with the Regional Bloc** — ModernGhana, 11 September 2026

  Tiani enrols first; five passport categories; Libyan firm Al Itissan Al-Jadeed producing; ECOWAS down to twelve.

- **Lancement officiel du passeport biométrique AES : le Niger se dote d'un nouveau document de voyage aux normes internationales** — ActuNiger, 16 September 2026

  Niger opened mass enrolment for the Sahel confederation's biometric passport in Niamey on 15 September 2026, with enrolment kits to go to every region and the diaspora. An ordinary passport costs 45,000 FCFA and runs five years, with online pre-enrolment through mobile money services.

AES BIOMETRIC NATIONAL IDENTITY CARD

- **CNIB AES à Agadez : Tarifs, pièces et enrôlement** — Journal du Niger, 15 September 2026

  Enrolment for the regional bloc's biometric national identity card opened in Agadez at the regional police headquarters, fingerprints and biometric parameters collected locally and processed centrally.

AES BIOMETRIC PASSPORT

- **Niger begins operational rollout of AES biometric passport** — Biometric Update, 18 September 2026

  Niger opened public enrolment for the Alliance of Sahel States biometric passport in Niamey on 15 September, with regional and diaspora centres and online pre-enrolment through mobile money to follow. An ordinary passport costs FCFA 45,000; Niger is the last of the three states to issue it.

Digital Payments and Fintech

MOBILE-MONEY PAYMENT AT THE VEHICLE ONE-STOP SHOP

- **Guichet Unique Automobile: SONILOGA ouvre le paiement de ses prestations à Airtel Money** — ActuNiger, 2 October 2026

  The operator of Niger's vehicle one-stop shop began accepting Airtel Money for some of its services on 1 October, through an app or an offline USSD code. The transport ministry presented it as a way to trace public revenue.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SECURE GOVERNMENT INTRANET

- **Ministère de la Communication et des NTI : le nouveau ministre Hamani Kargné officiellement installé** — ActuNiger, 24 September 2026

  Handover on 22 Sep; priorities: secure government intranet, rural-urban divide, start-ups, cybersecurity, post.

Capacity

Literacy

NATIONAL CAMPAIGN AGAINST DISINFORMATION

- **Citoyenneté numérique et paix : Lancement à Tillabéry de la 1ère Campagne nationale de lutte contre la désinformation** — MCNTI (Niger), 22 September 2026

  Launched 19 September at Tillabéry by NGO Jeunesse Plus with ministry backing; media-literacy workshops for youth.

Training and skills

DIGITAL SKILLS CENTRE PARTNERSHIP WITH ALGERIA

- **Cooperation Niger Telecom - Algerie Telecom : Un partenariat pour renforcer les capacites des infrastructures telecoms du Niger** — Le Sahel, 9 September 2026 ALGERIA

  Convention signed 8 September 2026 between ESCEP and Algerie Telecom's Skills Centers network.

- **Cooperation Niger - Algerie : Une delegation algerienne visite l'ESCEP dans le cadre d'un partenariat axe sur le numerique** — Le Sahel, 10 September 2026 ALGERIA

  Niger's telecommunications and post college received an Algerian mission led by the adviser for partnership and development of that country's operator skills-centre network. The visit follows a partnership accord of July aimed at establishing a digital competence centre, and is presented as reflecting the two heads of state's intent.

Inclusion

Access to services

NIGER DIGITAL DAY SKILLS CARAVAN

- **Diffa : Le Niger Digital Day renforce les competences numeriques des jeunes** — Agence Nigerienne de Presse (ANP), 3 September 2026

  Sixty participants at the Diffa leg of a digital-skills caravan touring all eight regions.

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